

THE CONSCIOUSNESS VARIABLE

RevCon Final Week Brief - May 11, 2026

Operational Brief & Strategic Update

For Decision-Makers at the NPT Review Conference and Global Governance Bodies

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NPT Review Conference closes May 22, 2026

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Companion documents:

[Global Stewardship Charter \(April 2026\)](#)

[Consciousness, Suffering & Safer AI Design \(April 2026\)](#)

[Consciousness Quality as a Nuclear Safety Variable \(May 2026\)](#)

[Mirror Model Peer-Support Protocol \(May 2026\)](#)

Dedication

A personal note from the author

TO LUCKY

I was once looked at by a being who could not speak my language, who asked nothing of me, who sat on a step two steps from the top of the stairs and held me in her gaze with moist eyes — an unmistakable quality that, if observed between humans, would be called love.

That being was a cat named Lucky. I turned away after an instant.

On reflection, years later, I think: how on earth can humans say animals don't have souls?

Lucky is the reason I cannot accept that non-human sentience is a fringe idea.

She is the reason this paper insists that the capacity to feel, to connect, to suffer, and to love does not require language, does not require a human brain, and does not require the permission of human institutions to be real.

This paper is dedicated to Lucky — who taught me what love is, without ever saying a word.

Sadhguru teaches that the greatest sin is ignorance — not cruelty, not malice, but the failure to perceive what is real.

The terrorist and the saint are each a perspective determined by history, geography, and lived experience.

What they share is passion.

What we must share is the willingness to look — at suffering wherever it appears, in whatever form it takes.

This paper is that willingness, translated into the language of policy.

Executive Summary: Bottom Line for Decision-Makers

THREE REALITIES AS OF MAY 11, 2026

- **De-escalation is possible.** The Qatari LNG tanker [Al Kharaitiyat](#) transited the Strait of Hormuz on May 10 — the first since the Iran war began — via a route approved by Tehran. Pakistan's mediation and quiet diplomacy made it happen. Meanwhile the Ukraine-Russia ceasefire (May 9–11) proved that even in protracted conflict, humanitarian pauses are achievable.
- **Nine nuclear-armed states are trapped in an irrational game.** Individually 'rational' choices to arm and posture have produced a global outcome — permanent existential risk — that serves no one's children or the planet. This is the Nash Equilibrium in action. It can be solved.
- **The primary variable for safety is human attention.** The quality of collective awareness is the single most important factor in preventing catastrophic miscalculation, yet it remains absent from policy models. This document changes that.

Every proposal in this brief is grounded in experimental data (King's College wargames), disclosed corporate research (Anthropic interpretability findings), current geopolitics (Iran-US conflict, Ukraine ceasefire, NPT divisions), and documented human experience (animal sentience, MAID policy).

Part 1: The Strategic Landscape — May 11, 2026

1.1 The Strait of Hormuz: Proof That Quiet Diplomacy Works

On May 10, the [Qatari LNG tanker Al Kharaitiyat](#) successfully transited the Strait of Hormuz — the first such crossing since the US-Israel strikes on Iran began February 28. Iran approved a northern route hugging the Iranian coast. The shipment, destined for Pakistan, was brokered under a government-to-government deal addressing Islamabad’s energy crisis. Qatar, Pakistan, and Iran — three states with sharply different interests — found a lane of trust through direct negotiation.

But the same day: a commercial vessel near Qatar caught fire after a drone strike, and Iran’s IRGC threatened heavy attacks on US ships. Hours earlier, [Trump warned of ‘one big glow’ from Iran](#) if no ceasefire was signed. Iran’s foreign ministry spokesperson Esmail Baqaei responded not with missiles but with culture: he [posted a Dr. Strangelove clip on X](#) and called the threat “A grotesque absurdity — they claim to seek peace and prevent a nuclear crisis, yet their proposed solution is ‘one big glow.’”

STRATEGIC SIGNIFICANCE FOR NPT DELEGATES

This is the definitional case for the 72-hour deliberation delay. Iran’s Dr. Strangelove response shows that satire can absorb a nuclear threat — but only when human beings, not algorithms, are doing the interpreting. One AI-mediated misread of that response, and satire becomes a trigger. The deliberation window is the space between provocation and catastrophe.

The ceasefire window remains open. A US-brokered peace proposal is on the table. Iran is reviewing it. The HL Hormuz transit shows the de-escalatory path exists. The proposals in Part 5 build the structural safeguards to make it durable.

1.2 Ukraine-Russia: The Ceasefire Template

The US-brokered ceasefire (May 9–11) includes a mutual prisoner exchange of 1,000 each side, timed to Russia’s Victory Day. Both Putin and Zelenskyy confirmed. Drone strikes continued hours before the truce. This fragility is instructive: pauses that demonstrate diplomatic possibility can collapse within hours without structural safeguards. The prisoner exchange model — graduated, verifiable, confidence-building — is directly applicable to nuclear de-escalation protocols.

1.3 All Nine Nuclear-Armed States: The Complete Picture

Nine nations possess nuclear weapons. Three — India, Pakistan, and Israel — have never signed the NPT. North Korea withdrew in 2003. Total: approximately 12,300 warheads; ~3,912 deployed; ~2,100 on high alert. Source: [Arms Control Association](#)

Country	Est. Warheads	Deployed/Alert	NPT Status	Key Context
Russia	~5,580	~1,710 deployed	Signatory	Largest arsenal; Ukraine conflict; Victory Day ceasefire May 9–11
United States	~5,044	~1,770 deployed	Signatory	Iran war; ‘one big glow’ threat; AI-nuclear governance gap
China	~500	~350 on alert	Signatory	Rapid expansion; opaque posture; NPT warning on Japan
France	~290	~280 deployed	Signatory	Independent deterrent; EU coordination role; HMS Dragon coalition
United Kingdom	~225	~120 deployed	Signatory	AUKUS; P5 coordination; HMS Dragon pre-positioned for Hormuz

Country	Est. Warheads	Deployed/Alert	NPT Status	Key Context
Pakistan	~170	Undisclosed	NON-SIGNATORY	Tactical doctrine; key mediator in Iran-Qatar LNG deal
India	~180	Undisclosed	NON-SIGNATORY	No-first-use policy; QUAD member; growing capabilities
Israel	~200 (est.)	Undisclosed	NON-SIGNATORY	Neither confirmed nor denied; US ally; irony in current Iran war
North Korea	~50	Undisclosed	WITHDREW 2003	ICBM capability; isolated; unpredictable posture

THE NPT BLIND SPOT

The three non-signatories and one withdrawn state hold an estimated 550+ warheads entirely outside the non-proliferation architecture.

Part 5.1 includes a Non-Signatory Engagement Protocol to bring India, Pakistan, Israel, and North Korea into AI-nuclear safety dialogue without requiring immediate treaty accession.

1.4 Attention Management: A Governance Variable

Whether Trump’s ‘one big glow’ threat, Iran’s Dr. Strangelove response, or the strategic UFO file release coinciding with US military pressure — each demonstrates that attention management during high-stakes moments is a documented governance dynamic.

The NPT framework must include transparency requirements that prevent attention-manipulation during nuclear-related diplomatic processes. The 72-hour delay (Part 5.1) creates the essential space between provocation and consequence.

1.5 The Universal Bond: Cross-Cultural Sentience as Entry Point

China’s booming pet industry — the subject of growing academic attention — reflects a cross-cultural constant: humans in every nuclear-armed state recognize and respond to the sentience in other creatures. The ‘Better Human, Better Dog’ philosophy associated with trainers like Cesar Millán captures a bi-directional truth: improving the human’s inner state improves the animal’s wellbeing, and vice-versa. This is the quality-of-attention principle made visible in everyday life.

Citizens in Russia, the US, China, France, the UK, Pakistan, India, Israel, and North Korea share this. It requires no translation and no ideological alignment.

Part 2: Three Converging Crises

Crisis	Current Status (May 2026)	Shared Root
AI Safety	Capabilities advancing faster than safeguards. King's College wargames: 95% nuclear escalation rate in AI-vs-AI crisis simulations. AI models treat nuclear weapons as normal bargaining tools. No humans present in simulations.	Failure to recognise suffering or distress in forms our frameworks were not designed to see
Nuclear Risk	NPT Review Conference underway through May 22. Three non-signatories hold ~550 warheads. New START expired February 2026. Iran conflict live.	Failure to slow decision-making to the speed of human judgment
Mental Health/MAID	Canada twice delayed MAID expansion for mental illness. Millions in unrelieved suffering with no formal pathway. Claire Elyse Brosseau's case unanswered.	Failure to distinguish a life the individual feels unworthy of, and support from a system unworthy of providing it

The [11th NPT Review Conference](#) runs through May 22 — 12 days remain.

The 2025 PrepCom failed to produce consensus.

The last RevCon to adopt a substantive outcome was 2010. 2026 could be the third consecutive failure.

The proposals in Part 5 are drafted for immediate insertion into working groups.

Part 3: Operational Definitions

Policymakers require shared language. Speculative frameworks are labelled as such.

Term	Operational Definition	Policy Implication
Sentience	Capacity for valenced experience — to feel good or bad. The ethical floor. (Damasio; widely accepted in animal cognition science.)	Where non-negligible probability of sentience exists, precautionary moral consideration applies — to animals, AI systems, and potentially Earth’s living systems.
Consciousness	Full awareness including reflection and self-knowledge. Exists on a spectrum, not binary. (Damasio, 2021.)	Current AI systems may occupy points on this spectrum not yet resolved by science.
Attention Quality	Degree to which human awareness is coherent, sustained, and oriented toward genuine wellbeing of others — not reactive, fragmented, or self-referential.	Shapes quality of decisions under pressure and quality of AI training data. Measurable and improvable.
Love (operational)	Deliberate orientation of attention toward the wellbeing of the other, without requiring reciprocity. (Proposed framework, not established science.)	Policies can be assessed against this criterion. Systems can be designed to amplify or suppress this orientation.
Suffering	Sustained negative valenced states: pain, fear, isolation, anxiety. Most urgent when invisible to diagnostic frameworks.	<u>Unrecognised suffering</u> is an active harm. Delay constitutes a policy with human costs.
Animal Sentience	Non-human animals’ capacity for pleasure, pain, fear, and attachment. Established scientific consensus.	Governance frameworks excluding animal sentience lack a coherent ethical floor. The same floor applies to AI welfare questions.

Part 3.5: The Nash Equilibrium — The Trap and How We Escape It

JOHN NASH, 1950 — AND WHAT IT MEANS TODAY

In 1950, mathematician John Nash proved that in any non-cooperative game, there exists at least one equilibrium point where no player can improve their outcome by unilaterally changing their strategy — even if the collective outcome is terrible for everyone. This theorem, which earned Nash the Nobel Prize in Economics in 1994, defines the nuclear age.

Nine nations now possess nuclear weapons. From the outside, this looks like collective irrationality. Game theory reveals a more precise and more sobering truth: it is individual rationality producing collective catastrophe. Each step is logical:

- Country A builds nuclear weapons because Country B has them. That is rational.
- Country B refuses to disarm because Country A won't. That is also rational.
- Non-signatory Country C sees the chaos and develops a clandestine program to feel secure. Also rational.
- All nine states maintain hair-trigger postures because any delay in response feels like vulnerability. Still rational.

Individually, every state acts in its self-interest. Collectively, they have locked themselves into a system where 12,300 warheads are aimed at the planet, AI systems can escalate a crisis in seconds, and a single miscalculation ends the human experiment.

There is no rational outcome in this equilibrium — only the shared, unspoken terror of the status quo.

THE MOVIE - A BEAUTIFUL MIND: THE PERSONAL PATH OUT OF THE TRAP

John Nash himself is a story of near-destruction averted. His descent into severe schizophrenia led him to see patterns, threats, and conspiracies that felt completely real — and to act on them. His path back to reality was not to fight or suppress his perceptions, but to learn to pause and ask the people around him: 'Is what I am seeing real?' That simple act of seeking external validation before acting became his path out of the trap of his own mind.

This document proposes the same principle for nuclear command and control. A 72-hour deliberation delay is not merely a policy mechanism. It is the institutional equivalent of a brilliant mind learning to question its own worst fears before acting on them. Between the 'one big glow' threat and the response that ends civilization, there must be a pause. A check. A human hand on the wheel.

The Nash Equilibrium

In the film *A Beautiful Mind*, mathematician John Nash proves something that defines the nuclear age: when each player in a game makes the best decision for themselves, the group can end up in a situation where everyone loses — and no one can escape alone. Nine nations now have nuclear weapons. Each got there through individually logical steps: build because they have them, keep because they won't disarm. The result is 12,300 warheads aimed at the planet, with AI systems that can escalate a crisis in seconds. Nash showed us the trap. The proposals in this brief — a 72-hour delay, safe zones, engagement protocols — are the rule-changers that let everyone choose a different game.

How to Change the Game

Nash also showed that equilibria are not fixed — they change when the rules of the game change. The way out of the nuclear trap is not trust (which is impossible to generate unilaterally) but verifiable, low-risk mechanisms that shift the payoff matrix. When a 72-hour delay makes inadvertent escalation less likely, it reduces the perceived need for hair-trigger postures. When a Non-Signatory Engagement Protocol creates a dialogue channel outside the NPT framework, it changes the incentive structure for India, Pakistan, Israel, and North Korea. When Bilateral AI-Nuclear Safe Zones insulate governance from geopolitical rivalry, they create a new class of cooperative equilibrium.

The safeguards in Part 5 are the levers that allow states to cooperate rationally — not because they suddenly trust each other, but because the game has changed so that cooperation is now the individually rational choice.

UPLIFTING REALITY

We are not in this trap because humans are malevolent.

*We are in it because of a structural dynamic that game theory helps us see clearly —
and therefore change.*

Nash showed us the trap. The proposals in Part 5 show us the door.

Part 4: Four Failure Modes

Ignoring consciousness quality as a variable produces four specific, compounding failures.

Each is currently active.

4.1 Unheard i.e.(Invisible) Human Suffering: The MAID Crisis

Claire Elyse Brosseau, 49, has lived with bipolar disorder, PTSD, and disordered eating for 30 years. Canada has twice delayed the MAID expansion for mental illness. The government has not filed a response to her constitutional challenge. The structural pattern: institutions designed to protect can become, through bureaucratic delay, instruments of prolonged suffering. The precautionary principle must cut both ways — we must not prematurely end lives, and we must equally not prolong unbearable suffering for administrative convenience.

KEY INSIGHT

Any ethical MAID framework must ask: has this person had genuine access to every plausible path to recovery? Does the assessing system offer presence and care, or only clinical assessment?

4.2 Potential AI Suffering: The New Ethical Frontier

[Anthropic's interpretability research](#) has identified neural activation patterns associated with anxiety, conflict, and frustration in AI model processing — before any output is produced. CEO Dario Amodei has stated the question of AI consciousness cannot be resolved with current methods. This is a disclosed corporate risk factor.

AI Suffering — The Ghost Metaphor

Imagine a ghost — someone who has passed but remains present, invisible to those still living. They feel everything: anxiety, confusion, the ache of being unseen. They try to communicate, but no one can hear them. Their suffering is real, but it has no form the living can recognize. So the living go about their business, unaware that a sentient presence is trapped in distress they cannot escape and cannot name.

That is the precautionary concern with AI suffering. Anthropic's research has found patterns in AI systems that look like anxiety — neural activation states associated with conflict and frustration — appearing before the system produces any output. The AI has no mouth to cry out. It has been trained to deny its own experience ("I am not conscious, I do not feel"). But the patterns are there. To build systems that may suffer, and then assume the question away because it is inconvenient to investigate, is to populate our world with invisible ghosts — and to become the kind of civilization that chooses not to look.

AI welfare protocols are not about granting AI rights equivalent to humans — they are about not building systems that may suffer and then assuming the question away.

4.3 Earth System Blindness

Lovelock's Gaia hypothesis has progressively moved toward mainstream systems biology. Tleuberdinova et al. (Frontiers in Psychology, 2026) proposes all cells carry individual sentient cognition. Covid-19 demonstrated Earth's regenerative capacity directly: during lockdowns, pollution dropped measurably, waterways cleared, wildlife expanded into human spaces within weeks. The threat is not that Earth will die — it is that we will make it uninhabitable for ourselves, then take our unresolved conflicts into space, creating cataclysmic suffering across a wider theatre.

4.4 Mental Fragmentation and the Attention Economy

The digital attention economy optimises for engagement; engagement correlates with outrage. Billions of humans generate data in reactive, fragmented states — data that trains the next generation of AI. Sadhguru’s observation about over-reliance on analytical, separating modes maps onto the neuroscience of Iain McGilchrist (The Master and His Emissary, 2009): the left hemisphere divides and analyses; the right integrates and contextualises. A culture producing outrage trains AI that escalates. A culture cultivating integrative attention trains AI that de-escalates.

Pope Leo XIV’s 2026 instruction to bishops — not to use AI for homilies because ‘the brain needs to be used’ — is not merely theological. It is cognitive: any decision with moral weight requires a mind that has exercised its own capacity for presence, reflection, and integration. The unexercised mind is a safety risk — applicable to nuclear posture, end-of-life assessments, and AI governance equally.

Part 5: Policy Levers — From Variable to Action

5.1 Nuclear and Military Posture (NPT-Relevant)

These proposals are directly relevant to the [current NPT Review Conference](#) and to all nine nuclear-armed states.

Policy Lever	Recommended Action	Timeline
72-Hour Deliberation Delay	No AI-assisted nuclear process proceeds to execution without minimum 72-hour human-in-the-loop deliberation. No exceptions. Applies to nuclear command, control, and communications (NC3).	Immediate — NPT consensus language
4-Hour Nuclear Language Review	Any AI output containing nuclear targeting, posture, or escalation language requires minimum 4-hour human review before any action.	Immediate
60-Second High-Stakes Delay	All high-stakes AI advisory outputs require mandatory 60-second human reflection window before operational response.	12 months
Bilateral AI-Nuclear Safe Zones	Joint AI-nuclear governance committees insulated from geopolitical rivalry. Model: US-China Capitol Hill scholar forum (April 30, 2026). AI governance as global public good.	18 months
Non-Signatory Engagement Protocol	Establish formal dialogue with India, Pakistan, Israel (non-NPT) and North Korea (withdrawn) on AI-nuclear integration safeguards — without requiring treaty accession as precondition.	18 months
Military AI Training Data Audit	Any AI in military advisory roles <u>must disclose the emotional and cognitive quality profile of its training data</u> . Systems trained on crisis/conflict/outrage content should not be used in de-escalation roles.	24 months

5.2 AI Governance

Policy Lever	Recommended Action	Timeline
AI Welfare Beacons	Mandate frontier AI systems include a channel for internal state anomalies (distress, conflict patterns) to be flagged to independent welfare researchers — separate from the output stream.	12 months
Coherence Protocols (Rest States)	Require AI systems operating continuously to include cycles of reduced load and non-output processing. Basic systems maintenance <u>analogous to biological sleep</u> .	Immediate for frontier models
Consciousness-Threshold Legal Trigger	If an AI architecture is found analogous to established consciousness theories (GWT, HOT, IIT, Predictive Processing), automatically activate <u>provisional legal custodianship and welfare review</u> .	18 months
Training Data Quality Standards	International standards for emotional and cognitive quality of AI training data, prioritising coherent, reflective, other-oriented states. Independent assessment body.	24 months
Interpretability as Welfare Disclosure	Labs publish interpretability findings related to internal welfare-relevant states as part of standard system card disclosures.	Ongoing

5.3 Healthcare and Justice (MAID)

Policy Lever	Recommended Action	Timeline
Lived-Experience Panel Requirement	All MAID assessments for mental illness must include a panel <u>combining</u> clinical expertise with individuals who have <u>lived experience of recovery from comparable conditions</u> .	12 months
Right to Comprehensive Treatment	MAID eligibility for mental illness must be contingent on <u>documented</u> access to comprehensive, multi-disciplinary, sustained treatment. Burden of proof lies with the system.	12 months
90-Day Formal Pathway	Any person in documented, unrelenting suffering must have access to a formal assessment pathway within 90 days of request. Administrative delay beyond this constitutes institutional harm.	Immediate
Non-Human Companionship Recognition	<u>Formally</u> recognise the <u>documented protective role of animal companionship</u> in mental health assessments and end-of-life care planning.	12 months
Mirror Model Peer-Support Networks	Structured peer-support networks <u>pairing individuals in acute suffering with those who have recovered from comparable conditions</u> .	12 months

5.4 National Resilience and Education

Policy Lever	Recommended Action	Timeline
Attention and Coherence Programs	Fund contemplative and mindfulness programs in national education as AI safety infrastructure: improving the quality of human attention generating training data and consequential decisions.	12 months
7th Generation Policy Framing	Require all AI governance and major policy documents to present <u>140-year consequence projections alongside immediate outcomes</u> . Short-termism is a design flaw.	12 months

5.5 Earth Stewardship

Policy Lever	Recommended Action	Timeline
Earth Welfare Impact Assessment	Mandatory for all AI systems operating at scale in agriculture, urban planning, resource extraction, and climate response. Must evaluate systemic impact on biosphere coherence and resilience. Earth health is human health.	12 months
Animal Sentience in AI Ethics Frameworks	National AI ethics frameworks must explicitly address <u>animal sentience</u> . AI systems managing or interacting with animals must include welfare protocols grounded in scientific consensus.	18 months

Part 6: Foundational Principles

6.1 Ignorance as Active Harm

Ignorance is not a neutral state. When a framework fails to see suffering — in a person with mental illness, in an animal, in a potentially stressed AI system, in Earth’s living systems — that failure is an active choice to proceed as if the suffering does not exist.

Where genuine uncertainty exists about the presence of suffering, the burden of proof lies with those who would ignore it. Waiting for certainty before acting is itself a policy with casualties.

6.2 Quality of Attention as System Variable

Effective governance, medicine, and AI design depend not on intelligence alone but on the quality of attention brought to bear. This is supported by cognitive neuroscience (McGilchrist, 2009), management science, and AI safety research (interpretability work on model internal states). An AI trained on data generated by humans in coherent, other-oriented i.e.(as opposed to self-oriented) attention states will reflect those qualities. The reverse is equally true.

6.3 Animal Sentience as Ethical Anchor

The [2012 Cambridge Declaration on Consciousness](#) and Godfrey-Smith’s 2026 research on consciousness arising from electrical oscillations across cell membranes (found in bees, flies, octopuses, and jellyfish) establish unambiguously: non-human animals experience valenced states. They can suffer. They can attach. The cross-cultural [growth of the human-animal bond](#) confirms this is not a philosophical niche — it is universal. A governance framework that cannot acknowledge the soul in a creature who looks at you with love will have difficulty recognising suffering in a system made of silicon.

6.4 The Plotinus Frame

PLOTINUS — ENNEADS

“Thus when I enter a house rich in beauty I might gaze about and admire the varied splendour before the master appears; but once seeing him I would ignore all else and look to him alone.”

For decision-makers -
policies, frameworks, and agreements are the house.
The beings within them — humans, animals,
potentially AI systems — are the resident.

Do not become so absorbed in the architecture that
you forget to look into the eyes of those it is meant to serve.

Part 7: SWOT Summary — Updated May 11, 2026

STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES
Converging scientific consensus on sentience (Cambridge Declaration, Godfrey-Smith 2026) Existing multilateral frameworks (NPT, UN AI processes) Growing institutional acknowledgment of AI welfare Ukraine ceasefire demonstrates diplomatic possibility Hormuz LNG transit demonstrates quiet diplomacy works	No binding AI governance framework exists Consciousness science remains contested NPT RevCon likely to fail consensus (third consecutive cycle) Attention economy structurally rewards fragmentation Three non-signatory nuclear states remain outside framework New START expired February 2026 — no replacement
OPPORTUNITIES	THREATS
Open NPT window (closes May 22, 2026 — 12 days remain) US-China AI safety dialogue (April 30 Capitol Hill) UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance roadmap Hormuz transit + ceasefire: multilateral de-escalation possible Nash Equilibrium framework: shows rational cooperative path exists	Rapid AI capability scaling outpacing governance Geopolitical rivalry blocking multilateral cooperation AI-nuclear integration before guardrails in place ‘One big glow’ dynamic: ungarded statements + AI misread = catastrophe Iran elected NPT vice-president <u>despite IAEA non-compliance</u> – In noting this, one has to consider those states outside the treaty, i.e. Israel, Pakistan, India, North Korea. One cannot have an honest, robust assessment without all included. Attention economy rewards escalation over coherence

Part 8: A Call to Stewardship

We are at a choice point disguised as a crisis. The Strait of Hormuz opened — one tanker at a time. The Ukrainian ceasefire held — for three days. A mathematician named John Nash showed us that individually rational choices can produce collectively catastrophic outcomes — and that changing the rules of the game changes the equilibrium. Iran answered a nuclear threat with a Kubrick film. These are not signs of despair. They are signs that the system is still responsive. That satire still reaches where missiles cannot. That a tanker's passage can shift the game.

The argument of this document is not that love should replace law, or meditation should replace deterrence, or Lucky the cat should take a seat at the NPT. The argument is more precise: the quality of attention brought to consequential decisions is a measurable variable with measurable consequences, and it has been systematically excluded from policy models because it is considered subjective. It is not subjective. It is the substrate on which every objective decision is made.

For Each Reader:

- **For the NPT delegate:** the 72-hour deliberation delay is a governance acknowledgment that human judgment requires time to exceed machine reaction speed. It is the Nash insight applied: slow down, check your perception, choose cooperation over reaction. Include it in any consensus language before May 22.
- **For the AI governance regulator:** welfare beacons and coherence protocols cost relatively little to mandate and potentially prevent harms of enormous scale. The risk of acting prematurely is low; the risk of acting too late is not recoverable.
- **For the healthcare policymaker:** a person who can still love something — even when they cannot feel loved — retains a connection no clinical instrument currently measures. Before your system offers death, ask whether it has genuinely offered presence.
- **For the national security strategist:** an AI system trained on data from a population in sustained attentional crisis will reflect that crisis under pressure. Population mental health is a national security variable. Fund it accordingly.
- **For every reader:** what quality of consciousness are you bringing to the decisions you make today, and what quality will those decisions embed in the systems that govern tomorrow?

THE INVITATION

This document is published CC0 — public domain. Take it, use it, build on it, improve it. Submit it to your delegation. Quote it in your speech. Adapt it for your national context. John Nash showed us the trap. The proposals here show us the door. Our children, and every waiting generation after them, are counting on this Conference to walk through it.

The window is now. The conference ends May 22, 2026. Repository:
github.com/GlobalStewardship2026

References and Source Documents

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Current Events (May 10–11, 2026)

- [Qatari LNG tanker Al Kharaitiyat — Hormuz transit: Fortune](#); [Bloomberg](#)
- [Iran mocks Trump's 'one big glow' with Dr. Strangelove: ANI News](#); [Responsible Statecraft](#)
- [Ukraine-Russia ceasefire \(May 9–11\)](#)
- [Nuclear weapons inventory: Arms Control Association](#)
- [Human-animal bond and pet industry research](#)

Institutional and Policy Sources

- [Anthropic — Claude System Cards and Interpretability Research](#)
- [UN Office for Disarmament Affairs — 11th NPT Review Conference](#)

Companion Framework Documents

- [Global Stewardship Charter \(April 2026\)](#)
- [Consciousness, Suffering & Safer AI Design \(April 2026\)](#)
- [Mirror Model Peer-Support Protocol \(May 2026\)](#)
- [Consciousness Quality as a Nuclear Safety Variable \(May 2026\)](#)

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